

How Vera should tap the biggest ube powder markets

A practical go-to-market report for export-grade Philippine ube powder: who to target, what to sell, and how to execute over the first 180 days.

The winning path is B2B validation first, then foodservice and retail after repeat demand is proven.

B2B first

importers, cafes, bakeries, ice cream,
beverage R&D, ingredient distributors

Sell verified Philippine-origin ube powder as an ingredient system, not a novelty.

The buyer is paying for consistency, documentation, origin and formulation usefulness.

1

Flagship

100% Philippine ube powder with specs, COA path and lot traceability.

3

First markets

US first, Europe/UK second, GCC third.

6

First buyer types

Importers, cafes, bakeries, ice cream, beverage R&D, ingredient distributors.

180

Days to proof

Samples, paid pilots, distributor validation and repeat orders.

Positioning: export-grade Philippine ube powder for brands that need real ube flavor, natural purple color, lot traceability and reliable documentation.

Start in the US, then expand to Europe/UK and GCC once documentation matures.

Each market needs a different entry channel and proof package.

Priority 1

United States

Best first market: Filipino diaspora, specialty food importers, cafe/bakery innovation, ice cream, beverage brands and visible 2026 mainstream ube validation.

Priority 2

Europe / UK

Strong cafe trend signal and premium product development market, but requires tighter importer, labelling and traceability discipline.

Priority 3

Middle East / GCC

Large Filipino communities, hotel/cafe dessert demand and premium foodservice. Requires halal path, Arabic label and distributor-led compliance.

Avoid opening too many fronts. Win one beachhead with samples, pilots and repeat orders before chasing every market.

The first buyer is not Starbucks; it is the buyer who can test, pay and reorder fast.

Rank buyer segments by speed to pilot and usefulness of feedback.

Segment	Primary target	Offer	Proof needed	Goal
Asian/Filipino importers	US, UK, UAE distributors	1kg/5kg/25kg powder	Origin, COA, price, shelf life	First revenue
Cafes/bakeries/ice cream	Operators who test fast	Sample kit + recipes	Application performance	Feedback + reorders
Ingredient distributors	Specialty and natural food	Pilot distribution	Supply reliability + docs	Scale channel
CPG/R&D teams	Beverage, dessert, snack brands	Technical sample kit	Specs, stability, MOQ	Co-development
Retail later	Specialty grocery/e-com	Small retail packs	Brand, labels, reviews	Later stage

Early buyer scorecard: can they test in 90 days, pay for a pilot, give formulation feedback and become a reference account?

Launch powder as the flagship, but sell it with applications.

Buyers do not just buy powder; they buy confidence that the powder works.

SKU 1 | Flagship

100% Philippine Ube Powder

For bakery, ice cream, fillings and food manufacturing. Pack sizes: 100g sample, 500g R&D, 1kg chef, 5kg foodservice, 20/25kg B2B.

SKU 2 | Prototype

Beverage-Ready Blend

For lattes, cold foam, milk tea and frappes. Useful because pure powder may need blending support for drinks.

SKU 3 | Later

Foodservice Ube Base

A thicker base for cafes, bakeries, ice cream and fillings after buyer feedback validates common use cases.

Do not lead with ube VCO. Keep VCO, halaya and extracts as channel-specific extensions after proof.

Own authenticity, consistency and documents; avoid exaggerated wellness claims.

The strongest commercial pain is reliable real ube, not another purple trend product.

Use

Buyer-safe language

- Authentic Philippine origin
- Verified supply
- Consistent color
- Documented lots
- Clean ingredient
- Foodservice-ready
- Export-ready
- Formulation support

Avoid

Diligence-risk language

- Superfood miracle claims
- Unlimited supply
- Global exports are already huge
- Better than matcha
- Purple powder only
- VCO as flagship
- Unverified health benefits

Best phrase: Vera supplies export-grade Philippine ube powder for food and beverage brands that need authentic ube flavor, natural purple color, lot traceability and reliable documentation.

Days 1-30: make Vera credible before serious buyer outreach.

The first deliverable is a buyer-ready product and documentation package.

Workstream	Deliverable	Owner	Done when
Product spec	Ingredient name, botanical name, origin, moisture, mesh, shelf life, storage, allergens	Chris	One-page spec is ready
Processor/lab	3 processor quotes and 3 lab options	Marc + Chris	Costs and lead times logged
Supply	Supplier intake form and first raw ube map	Marc	10 supply leads entered
Digital	Landing page, inquiry form, product one-pager	Chris	Buyer can request samples
CRM	Buyer database and outreach tracker	Chris	First 100 leads loaded

Days 30-60: send sample kits that make formulation easy.

A sample kit should include product, proof and recipes.

Sample formats

Three packs

- 100g pure powder sample
- 500g chef/R&D sample
- Application sample kit with recipes

Do not rely on a plain pouch alone.

Inside every kit

Proof pack

- Product spec sheet
- COA or testing note
- Storage guide
- MOQ/pricing guide
- Buyer feedback form
- QR code to site/data room

Applications

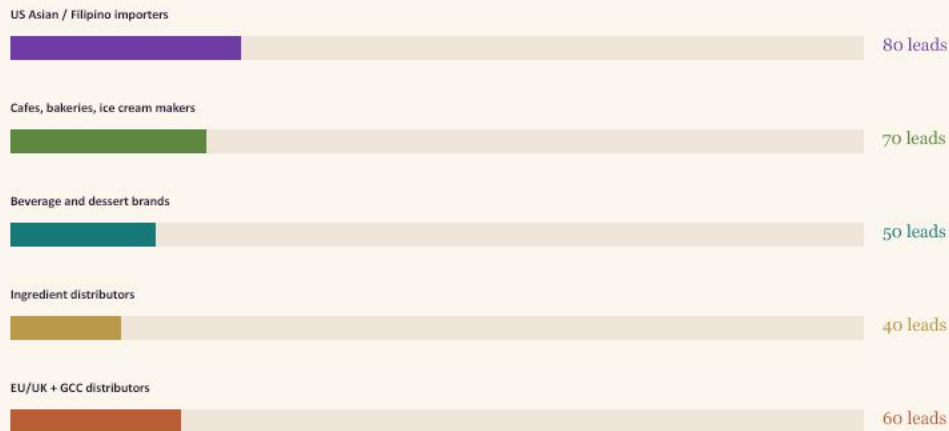
Recipe proof

- Ube latte
- Ube cake
- Ube ice cream
- Ube cream filling
- Ube bread/pandesal
- Ube smoothie/protein shake

The objective is to reduce buyer work. The easier it is to test, the faster they tell Vera whether the product can become recurring demand.

Days 45-90: run a 300-lead buyer outreach sprint.

The goal is not vanity meetings; it is sample requests, feedback and paid pilots.



Sequence

Five touches

1. Email intro
2. LinkedIn connect
3. WhatsApp/call for importers
4. Product one-pager
5. Sample offer + feedback deadline

Days 90-150: convert samples into paid pilots.

A small paid order is more valuable than a huge non-committal expression of interest.

Pilot ladder

Start small

- 5kg trial pack
- 10kg foodservice trial
- 25kg distributor test bag
- 50kg R&D batch
- 100kg early commercial order

Success criteria

What counts

- Buyer pays something
- Buyer tests product
- Buyer gives feedback
- Buyer confirms reorder conditions
- Vera validates landed cost

Do not chase

Scale traps

Do not accept a 1MT order before supply, processor capacity, COA timing, packaging and freight economics are proven.

Pilot documentation to capture: application, required specs, price, freight, issues, reorder probability and volume potential.

Give territory only after performance, not after enthusiasm.

Use short trials before exclusivity.

Region	Distributor criteria	Trial offer	Exclusivity trigger
US	Imports Asian/Filipino or specialty ingredients; understands FDA/FSVP; sells to foodservice or specialty retail	25-100kg pilot	Minimum purchase + buyer list
EU/UK	Established food importer; can act as food business operator/importer; understands traceability and labelling	Sample + pilot pallet	Regulatory + sales proof
GCC	Halal-capable; Filipino channel access; hotel/restaurant/cafe relationships; Arabic label support	25kg trial	Local registration + reorder
Rule	No exclusivity at first. 3-month trial distribution with clear minimum purchase target.	Performance first	Written milestone

Documentation is part of the product, not admin work.

For ingredient buyers, the easiest supplier to approve has an advantage.

US

Import basics

FDA facility registration if applicable
US importer with FSVP responsibility
Prior Notice for shipments
Ingredient/allergen review
COA and batch records

EU / UK

Traceability and labels

Importer / food business operator
Mandatory labelling
Batch/lot coding
Allergen and ingredient declarations
Pesticide/heavy metal/micro controls

GCC

Distributor-led compliance

Halal path
Arabic label requirements
Importer registration
Shelf-life documentation
Local distributor guidance

Practical move: build a buyer data room before shipment: specs, COA, process flow, supplier forms, allergen statement, batch code guide and storage instructions.

Use three price levels before quoting volume commitments.

Do not quote large-order pricing until yield, processing, testing, freight and distributor margin are known.

Level 1

Sample price

Small packs priced to filter serious buyers. Free only for high-quality prospects with real volume potential.

Level 2

Pilot price

5kg to 25kg. Must cover product, handling, testing allocation, documents and freight admin.

Level 3

Commercial price

100kg+. Based on landed cost, processing, packaging, testing, export cost, freight, duties, distributor margin and target gross margin.

Pricing gate: no scale promise until Vera knows raw ube cost, conversion yield, processing cost, moisture loss, lab cost and working-capital cycle.

Marc sells and secures supply; Chris builds the system that makes selling credible.

Weekly deliverables should match the equity/time split.

Marc | Full-time

Commercial and supply engine

- 10 buyer calls/messages weekly
- 5 supplier/processor conversations
- 3 investor updates or meetings
- 1 weekly pipeline report
- 1 supply/cost update

Focus: relationships, supply, processors, investor conversations and closing paid pilots.

Chris | Part-time

Product and operating system

- 50 new buyer leads weekly
- 1 improved sales/document asset
- CRM updated
- Compliance tracker maintained
- Website/content improved
- Sample feedback organized

Focus: product specs, website, CRM, documents, data room and application guides.

The first six months should produce proof of repeatable demand, not just awareness.

Move from readiness to samples to paid pilots to distributor validation.

1-15

Product spec + lead database

Finalize specs, processors, labs, website and sample kit design.

16-30

First sample batch

Processor quote, product one-pager, email sequence, 100-lead outreach.

31-60

Sample testing

Send 20-30 kits, collect feedback, test applications, refine specs.

61-90

Paid pilots

Close 3-5 pilots, validate landed cost, secure supplier MOUs.

91-120

First recurring buyer

Complete lab testing, create case study, approach distributors.

121-180

Distributor pilot

Secure one pilot, sell 250-500kg cumulative, prepare investor update.

Start with buyer types that can test and reorder quickly.

Named lead lists should be built under these 10 target categories.

- | | | | |
|----|---|----|--|
| 01 | US Filipino food importer | 06 | London specialty cafe/dessert operator |
| 02 | US Asian grocery distributor | 07 | UAE Filipino food distributor |
| 03 | California Filipino bakery group | 08 | Dubai hotel pastry supplier |
| 04 | New York / New Jersey Filipino dessert cafe | 09 | US ice cream/gelato manufacturer |
| 05 | UK Filipino/Asian importer | 10 | Beverage powder / latte mix brand |

Operating mantra: start B2B, prove repeat orders, then earn the right to scale into distributors, larger manufacturers and retail.